



Lineage	Subspecies	Traits of selected subspecies
African (A) “A” is for African	<i>Apis mellifera adansonii</i> <i>Apis mellifera capensis</i> <i>Apis mellifera intermissa</i> <i>Apis mellifera litorea</i> <i>Apis mellifera major</i> <i>Apis mellifera monticola</i> <i>Apis mellifera sahariensis</i> <i>Apis mellifera scutellata</i> <i>Apis mellifera simensis</i>	<i>Apis mellifera capensis</i> is called the Cape honey bee. It is found in the southwestern tip of Africa. It has a small dark body and is not very defensive. This is the only subspecies of honey bee in which workers can lay eggs that develop into females. In all other subspecies, worker-laid eggs develop into males. <i>Apis mellifera scutellata</i> is found from the cape of South Africa to Ethiopia, in eastern Africa. These bees can withstand <i>Varroa</i> infestations without the need for treatment better than European subspecies. They can be highly defensive. This subspecies was introduced to Brazil, where they mated with feral populations, resulting in Africanized honey bees.
European (M) “M” is for <i>mellifera</i>	<i>Apis mellifera iberiensis</i> <i>Apis mellifera mellifera</i> <i>Apis mellifera sicula</i> <i>Apis mellifera ruttneri</i>	<i>Apis mellifera mellifera</i> was the first subspecies brought over to the New World and is commonly referred to as the German black bee. It is a big, dark honey bee with long body hairs. It is relatively defensive and has a tendency to run on the comb. Its natural range is from the south of France extending eastward all the way to the Ural Mountains in Russia.
Eastern Europe (C) “C” is for <i>carnica</i>	<i>Apis mellifera adami</i> <i>Apis mellifera carnica</i> <i>Apis mellifera cecropia</i> <i>Apis mellifera cypria</i> <i>Apis mellifera macedonica</i> <i>Apis mellifera ligustica</i>	<i>Apis mellifera carnica</i> is sometimes referred to as the “Carniolan” bee or the “bee of the Alps”. These bees tend to be gentle and calm on the comb. They overwinter well in cold climates, and rapidly build up in spring. They were originally found in Hungary, Austria, Romania, Bulgaria, Slovenia, Croatia, and Serbia. <i>Apis mellifera ligustica</i> is the most common subspecies in North America. It is often referred to as the “Italian” bee, as it was originally found in Italy and introduced to North America in the 1860s. This gentle bee has yellow, gold, and light brown coloration. Colonies are capable of rapid growth when there are floral resources available and decrease brood production in the fall more than other subspecies in the U.S.
Near East and Central Asia (O) “O” is for Oriental	<i>Apis mellifera anatoliaca</i> <i>Apis mellifera caucasica</i> <i>Apis mellifera meda</i> <i>Apis mellifera pomonella</i> <i>Apis mellifera syriaca</i>	<i>Apis mellifera caucasica</i> is known as the Caucasian bee, and is from the Caucasus Mountains in Russia, Georgia, Armenia, and Turkey. The worker bees have gray hairs, while drones have characteristic black hairs on their thoraces. In general, these bees are gentle; they build up slowly in the spring and are less likely to swarm. They are also tolerant of cold temperatures.
Western Asia (Y) “Y” is for <i>yemenitica</i> , an alternative name to <i>jemenitica</i>	<i>Apis mellifera jemenitica</i>	
Madagascar (U) “U” is for <i>unicolor</i>	<i>Apis mellifera unicolor</i>	
Egypt (L) “L” is for <i>lamarckii</i>	<i>Apis mellifera lamarckii</i>	